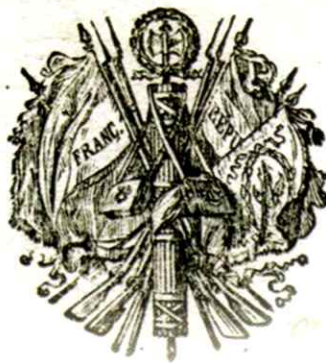


Armée

Liberté.



Egalité.



N HISTORY SHEET N

This sheet provides some historical background to the Event Cards in Legion of Honor. This is the historical narrative within which the Groggnard steers his life to achieve fame and success.

I-1 Louis XVI Arrested: The Duke of Brunswick – commanding the Prussian Army – issues a manifesto denouncing the French National Assembly and threatening death to any Frenchman acting against Louis XVI. Asserting their disdain for the Duke and suspicion of Louis, the revolutionaries arrest the King. Reform becomes violent revolution, and French populist nationalism is born.

I-2 You Are Denounced: At this time, many Frenchmen – Lafayette, for example – are denounced as traitors to France and the Revolution.

I-A Battle of Valmy: In response to the King's arrest, the Duke of Brunswick marches on Paris, making good on his threat. The nationalist French Army, relying on raw recruits, prevails and drives the Prussians out of France.

I-B Battle of Jemappes: The revolutionary French armies liberate Belgium from its aristocratic overlords.

II-1 Louis XVI Guillotined: By beheading the King, the leaders of the revolution hope to thwart counterrevolution. The Bourbons will not forgive.

II-A Battle of Neerwinden: Prussia and Austria prevail over the Army of the North, retaking the lost territory in Belgium.

II-A Fire on Dumouriez: The Army of the North commander defects at Neerwinden. He is generally assumed to have set up his army for defeat at the battle.

II-B Rebellion in the Vendee: Rebellion against the Paris regime is most prevalent in the Vendee. Fratricide follows regicide.

II-B Siege of Toulon: Buonaparte achieves his first success by freeing France's primary naval base on the Mediterranean from Albion.

II-C The Terror: Oppression begat revolution, which begat regicide, which begat fratricide, which begat the Terror. Reason becomes madness.

II-C Battle of Fleurus: Neerwinden is avenged, and the Low Countries embrace the revolution.

III-1 Coup d'état of 9 Thermidor: Revenge of the Bourgeoisie. Robespierre has a tête à tête with Madam Guillotine.

III-2 Coup d'état of 13 Vendémiaire: Counterrevolutionaries get a whiff of grapeshot from Buonaparte. The Parisians lose their taste for political violence.

III-3 Marriage of Buonaparte & Josephine: The Directory's strong man wins a wife.

III-A The Bridge at Lodi: Buonaparte and Massena seize the bridge at Lodi by coup de main. The courage and energy of their little corporal wins the devotion of the Army of Italy. The legend is born.

III-A Battle of Castiglione: Buonaparte's first large battle. A masterpiece of timing and execution.

III-B Ride with the Guides at Arcola: This time the coup de main at the bridge failed, but Buonaparte's determination finds a solution. The battle is won by his elite bodyguard's audacious ruse de guerre.

III-B Battle of Rivoli: One of Buonaparte's most brilliant victories. A strategic masterpiece and a fitting partner to Castiglione.

IV-1 Würmser's Capitulation at Mantua: Würmser surrenders Mantua, Austria's impregnable fortress in Northern Italy. The ceremony is a grand, elegant spectacle, showing magnanimity for the vanquished.

IV-2 Coup d'état of 18 Fructidor: The forces of counterrevolution are again thwarted as all royalist sympathizers are purged. Buonaparte's general, Augereau, provides the necessary muscle.

IV-A Battle of the Pyramids: Political instability in Paris induces Buonaparte to undertake his Egyptian adventure to avoid the tumult at home. The Mamelukes are tamed in sight of the Pyramids.

IV-B Battle of First Zurich: Massena, Buonaparte's right hand in 1797, withstands the Austrians in Switzerland.

IV-B Battle of Trebbia: The Russians and Austrians under Suvorov defeat MacDonald.

IV-C Battle of Aboukir: Buonaparte defeats the Turkish Janissaries trying to liberate Egypt from the western infidels.

IV-C Battle of Novi: Joubert, the hero of Rivoli, dies in defeat at the hands of Suvorov and his veteran Russian Army.

IV-C Battle of Second Zurich: Massena's brilliant victory preserves the Helvetic Republic from its former Hapsburg overlords.

IV-C Battle of Castricum: The Duke of York and his Russian partners fail to restore the House of Orange to the Batavian Republic (Holland).

V-1 Coup d'état of 18 Brumaire: The reign of the Directory ends as Buonaparte's grenadiers clear the chamber of the Five Hundred. The Consulate is established with you know who as First Consul.

V-A Cross Alps at St. Bernard Pass: With Italy lost, the First Consul dares to follow in the footsteps of Hannibal. David paints the event in all its heroic dimensions.

V-A Battle of Marengo: Uncharacteristically compounding error upon error, the First Consul almost loses. Having lost one battle, Marmont, Kellerman, and Desaix win him another, but Desaix dies. Buonaparte's reputation as invincible is proven. "Give me a general who is lucky," he once said. Q.E.D.

V-B Battle of Hohenlinden: Marengo wins back Northern Italy, but victory over the forces of reaction requires much more. Buonaparte's principal rival, Moreau, provides this in Germany at Hohenlinden.

VI-1 The Infernal Machine: Over Christmas, Royalists attempt to assassinate the First Consul on the streets of Paris on his way to the opera. He will have his revenge.

VI-2 The Fall of Moreau & Pichegru: General Pichegru is arrested, confesses to collaborating with royalists, names names, and then conveniently commits "suicide." Moreau is one of those named, but is permitted to go into exile. With Moreau gone, the loyalty of the army to Buonaparte is secured.

VI-3 Execution of Duc D'Enghien: The alleged mastermind of the Infernal Machine, this charismatic but dangerous Bourbon is kidnapped, summarily tried, and executed in an act of judicial murder. The ruthless Minister of Police, Fouché, describes it best: "It is worse than a crime. It is a mistake."

VI-4 Creation of the Marshalate: Napoleon grants his senior commanders the title of Marshal of France. The marshal's baton becomes the Holy Grail of the Army. Inexplicably, Napoleon's old friend, Marmont, hero of Marengo, was not so honored and waited five more years for his title. Marmont would not forget this slight.

VI-4 Grand Review at Boulogne: The encampment on the English Channel was intended for the invasion of England. Bonaparte here forged the Grand Army into the most efficient and capable army the world had seen for centuries. Napoleon celebrated their achievement with a rite of passage.

VI-5 Crowning of Napoleon: The Republic becomes the Empire. Imperial nobility and the Legion of Honor are established.

VII-A Battle of Elchingen: The Grand Army abandons its designs on Great Britain and marches from Boulogne to Germany. His victory at Elchingen enables Napoleon to bag the unfortunate General Mack and his Austrian Army in Ulm.

VII-A Capture of the Danube Bridge: With no army between Ulm and Vienna, the Grand Army descends the Danube to seize the Austrian capital. Murat and Lannes employ a ruse de guerre to seize a bridge over the Danube, thus assuring Vienna's immediate fall.

VII-B Battle of Austerlitz: With the Russian Czar marching to Austria's



rescue, the Austrian Emperor refuses to surrender. Outnumbered and overextended, the Grand Army and Napoleon achieve their greatest victory on December 2, 1805.

VIII-A Battles of Jena and Auerstadt: The heirs of Frederick the Great are destroyed on two separate battlefields on the same day. Napoleon defeats the Prussian rearguard, while Marshal Davout's corps alone defeats the main enemy army.

IX-1 Christmas Camp in Warsaw: The forces of the Revolution liberate Poland. A grateful nation welcomes them as heroes.

IX-A Battle of Eylau: Despite Jena-Auerstadt, the Prussians fight on, hoping for the Russian Emperor to rescue them. The French and Russians slug it out in the January snows. Holding the field of battle, the French claim victory, but the French VII Corps is destroyed.

IX-B Capitulation of Danzig: The fall of Danzig is essential in order to provide the French lines of communication into Eastern Poland and Prussia.

IX-B Battle of Friedland: For nine months, the Russian army campaigns against Napoleon. At Friedland, the French finally force a decisive victory. The Russian Czar has finally had enough.

X-1 Peace of Tilsit: The Emperor needs to consolidate his conquests, and the Czar is demoralized by his lack of success. At Tilsit, Napoleon's skill at spectacle wins more than a peace treaty; he wins an alliance with the Czar, a tremendous political victory.

X-2 Revolt of May 2nd, 1808: Napoleon meddles in Spanish domestic affairs and places his brother Joseph on the throne. The nation revolts, making Spain the French Army's "bleeding ulcer."

X# Battle of Medina de Rioseco: Marshal Bessieres crushes a Spanish army and holds the line of the Ebro.

X# Battle of Baylen: Castanos' Spanish forces surround and destroy General Dupont. It is the first clear defeat for the Grand Army. The myth of invincibility is broken.

X# Battle of Tudela: A second Spanish army is crushed by the Emperor. The way to Madrid lies open.

X# Battle of Vimeiro: Sir Arthur Wellesley defeats Marshal Junot but is recalled.

X# Battle of Corunna: Sir John Moore, Wellesley's successor, dies evacuating the British from northwestern Spain under the pressure of Marshal Soult.

XI-A Siege of Saragossa: This is a savage struggle to subdue a non-compliant people. The Grand Army is shocked at the need to fight civilians as well as soldiers.

XI-A Battle of Medellin: The Spanish are driven back to Andalusia. The way is open to recapture Portugal.

XI-A Battle of Eckmühl: The Austrians return for more in 1809. After first surprising the French, the French defeat the Austrians in Bavaria and pursue them back to Austria.

XI-B Battle of Talavera: Sir Arthur Wellesley returns to lead the British army. Napoleon's brother, Joseph, is defeated, but Wellesley and his Spanish allies retire to their bases in the West. Sir Arthur becomes the Duke of Wellington.

XI-B Capture of Vienna: After Eckmühl, the main Austrian army retires to Bohemia. Napoleon outraces them to Vienna, which falls without a fight. From the safety offered by the Danube, the Archduke Charles shadows the French in Vienna.

XI-B Battle of Aspern-Essling: Seeking to force a battle, Napoleon unwisely bridges the Danube in flood and crosses. Charles counterattacks, and Napoleon is personally defeated for the first time.

XI-C Battle of Wagram: In his largest battle, the Emperor exacts his revenge for Aspern-Essling. Despite the treacherous Bernadotte's "telling maneuver" with his IX Corps, the French prevail.

XI-C Battle of Ocana: The French dragoons roll up five divisions of the main Spanish army in a massive cavalry charge.

XI-C Siege of Gerona: Though smaller in size, Gerona is an even greater nightmare than Saragossa for its participants.

XII-1 Marriage of Napoleon & Marie Louise: In need of an heir, Napoleon divorces the infertile Josephine and weds the daughter of the Austrian Emperor.

XII-2 Birth of the King of Rome: Marie-Louise gives the Emperor a son who is made King of Rome. The dynasty is assured.

XII# Battle of Albuera: The allied force of English, Spanish, and Portuguese hold the field against Marshal Soult in a ferocious fight.

XII# Battle of Fuentes de Onoro: Again, Wellington prevails against Massena, but just barely.

XII# Battle of Bussaco: Wellington holds the high ground against Marshal Massena but is outflanked and retires to Portugal.

XII# Battle of Saguntum: Suchet crushes the Spanish on the Mediterranean coast. For his success, he wins his baton.

XIII-A March into Russia: The campaign of 1812 finds the Emperor waging his style of war in a vast country with a primitive road network. The huge French Army faces logistical problems on a scale never before attempted. Unseen catastrophe looms.

XIII-A Battle of Salamanca: Wellington defeats Marshal Marmont in a near run thing and forces the evacuation of Madrid.

XIII-B Battle of Borodino: The French hold the field and claim victory in the bloodiest battle of Napoleon's career. A French defeat might not have been as bad as the campaign's final result.

XIII-C Burning of Moscow: The Emperor's plan to billet his troops over winter in Moscow literally goes up in flames. The French must return from whence they came.

XIII-C Cross the Berezina: Napoleon and a skeleton crew of the Grand Army escape across the Berezina River before the ice and bridges collapse, leaving behind vast amounts of men and treasure.

XIV-A Battles of Lützen and Bautzen: With a new army assembled, the Emperor tries to hold onto Germany, but Prussia and Austria have joined forces with Russia. They fight to a draw.

XIV-A The Armistice: The armies rest and recover as all sides feel the need for reinforcements in order to resume the offensive.

XIV-B Battles of Dresden & Katzbach: Refusing to fight Napoleon himself, the Austrians retire from Dresden. Meanwhile, the Swedes, Russians, and Prussians defeat the French at Dennewitz. On the Katzbach, Blucher and the Army of Silesia push the French back into central Germany.

XIV-B Battle of Vitoria: Having lost Madrid, the French retire to the Ebro to consolidate forces. The attempt is too little, too late. Wellington's victory liberates Spain.

XIV-C Battle of Leipzig: For three days in and around Leipzig, the Prussian, Russian, Austrian, and Swedish armies close in on the Grand Army and crush it. Germany is lost.

XV-A Battle of La Rothiere: The remnants of the Grand Army and new recruits enable the Emperor to defend France against the invading forces of monarchist reaction. At La Rothiere, the French suffer a setback, but the allies squander the victory.

XV-B Battles of the Six Days of Glory: Napoleon and Marmont ambush the allies and hand them two serious setbacks at Montmirail and Vau-champs. In these two battles, Napoleon shows the skill of his prime. These two battles are together the last hurrah.

XV-B Battle at Orthez: The French armies of Spain, now driven into Southern France, again face Wellington with predictable results.

XVI-1 The Abdication: Marshal Marmont, Napoleon's oldest but slighted comrade, surrenders his command and opens the gates of Paris to the enemy. Napoleon accepts exile to Elbe.

XVI-2 The Emperor Returns: Napoleon escapes from Elbe and lands in Southern France.

XVI-2 The March on Paris: Marshal Ney, who had sworn loyalty to the Bourbons, marches with an army to arrest Napoleon, but turns it over to the Emperor instead. Together, they march on Paris.

XVI-A1 Battle of Ligny: Napoleon drives a wedge between Wellington and Blucher and defeats the tenacious Prussians at Ligny. However, he fails to keep contact as the Prussians retreat.

XVI-A2 Battle of Quatre Bras: Marshal Ney fights Wellington inconclusively. I Corps marches to and fro but does not get into the fight.

XVI-A3 Battle of Wavre: Marshal Grouchy pursues the Prussians but fights only a single corps at Wavre. The other three Prussian corps have marched on Waterloo.

XVI-A4 Battle of Waterloo: Wellington's allied army takes a beating but holds on while the Prussians cave in the French right. Wellington orders a general advance and the Grand Army retreats. The Old Guard covers the retreat. When told to lay down their arms, they answer: "The Guard dies. It never surrenders."

Denouement: Napoleon is exiled to St. Helena in the South Atlantic for the rest of his life. The Bourbon Monarchy tries Marshal Ney and executes him for supporting the Emperor's return. Oh, that it had ended differently!